Funded Ph.D. positions in low-power AI chip design at the University of Aizu, Japan

The University of Aizu (Japan) and Le Quy Don Technical University (Vietnam) invite Vietnamese researchers to apply for **two funded Ph.D. positions** in the JST NEXUS Japan–Vietnam project "Low-Power Event-Driven AI System-on-Chip for Edge Computing" (2027–2030).

- JST NEXUS grant number: JPMJNX26D3
- JST NEXUS projects: https://www.jst.go.jp/aspire/nexus/en/project/index.html (English), https://www.jst.go.jp/aspire/nexus/project/index.html (Japanese)

The research

The project builds an ultra-low-power AI chip that works with an event camera and only computes when something in the scene changes. Ph.D. students take part in the full chip flow: AI models, hardware design (RTL), FPGA prototyping, and the design, tapeout and testing of real chips.

What we offer

- Ph.D. study at the University of Aizu, in English
- A JST research stipend of ¥2.4 million a year (¥200,000 a month) until June 2030
- A personal research budget of ¥1.5 million a year
- Hands-on experience from AI algorithm to fabricated silicon
- Workshops and research visits in Japan and Vietnam
- Career support for industry, start-ups and academia in Japan, Vietnam and abroad

Who can apply

- Vietnamese nationality
- A master's degree (or completing one) in electronics, computer engineering, computer science or a related field
- Interest or experience in digital/FPGA design, chip design, or neural networks
- English: IELTS 5.5, TOEIC L&R 600, TOEFL iBT 65 or Duolingo 95 or higher (test taken within the last 2 years), or a previous degree taught in English
- Not active military personnel

Start dates

- April 2027 (entrance exam on January 30, 2027)
- October 2027 (entrance exam in July 2027)

Selected candidates must also pass the University of Aizu doctoral entrance exam. Key dates for the April 2027 start:

Step	Date
University application period	Monday, December 7 – Monday, December 14, 2026, 5:00 PM (JST)
Entrance exam (interview)	Saturday, January 30, 2027
Results announced	Friday, February 5, 2027, around 11:00 AM (JST)
Ph.D. starts	April 2027

- Admission information: https://u-aizu.ac.jp/en/admissions/graduate/doctor/
- Application guidelines (AY2027 Spring): https://u-aizu.ac.jp/files/admissions/2027_d_e.pdf

How to apply

Email a CV, a short research statement (1–2 pages), academic transcripts and an English test score to **khanh@u-aizu.ac.jp**, with the subject "NEXUS Ph.D. application – Your Name".

Deadline for the April 2027 start: Friday, November 20, 2026, 5:00 PM (JST). Shortlisted candidates are interviewed online in the week of November 23, and selected candidates then apply to the university between December 7 and 14, 2026.

Contact

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